

SKILLS GUIDE



Good speaking and listening skills for communicating with pilots and other personnel.



Excellent organizational skills to coordinate the arrival and departure of simultaneous flights.



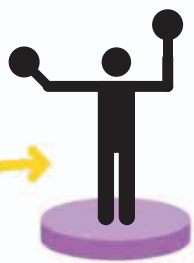
Good numerical skills to ensure accurate calculation of the speed of aircraft and distance traveled.



The ability to solve complex and urgent problems with rapid, safe, and innovative solutions.



Concentration, accuracy, and attention to detail for ensuring that aircraft safety is maintained.



APPROACH AND DEPARTURE CONTROLLER Maintains contact with aircraft pilots as flights arrive or depart from an airport, arranging the sequence of landing and takeoff, and keeping pilots updated on weather conditions and other vital information.



TOWER/AERODROME CONTROLLER Works in an airport control tower to guide pilots in to land. Tower controllers also direct planes on the ground to ensure they reach the correct parking stand. They also coordinate the movement of service vehicles, such as baggage carts.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **AIRLINE PILOT** *see pp. 214–215*
- ▶ **AIRLINE CABIN CREW** *see pp. 308–309*
- ▶ **AIRCRAFT MAINTENANCE ENGINEER** Performs routine maintenance checks on aircraft to inspect them for defects, carry out repairs, and keep them in excellent flying condition. Aircraft maintenance engineers also undertake functional checks on internal aircraft systems, such as engines and instrument panels.

In the United States alone, air traffic controllers coordinate the movements of up to 50,000 planes a day.

AT A GLANCE



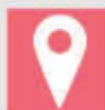
YOUR INTERESTS Aviation • English • Mathematics • Physics • Engineering • Information Technology (IT) • Electronics • Transportation



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A good general education, including English and mathematics, is needed to start training. A relevant college degree is useful.



LIFESTYLE Working hours are regular, but controllers work in shifts to cover nights, weekends, and holidays in order to track flights over a 24-hour period.



LOCATION Controllers usually work on computers and radar tracking equipment in an office, or within an airport control tower or center.



THE REALITIES Responsibility for the safety of aircraft and passengers requires intense concentration, and can be stressful and exhausting.